

Didi's SoulFood Treasury

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Didi's SoulFood Treasury

44 Recipes from the Heart of the Kitchen

Don't count calories — count your smiles and steps.

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All recipes, photographs, and texts in this book are the original work of the author unless otherwise stated.

Acknowledgements

First and foremost, I want to thank my mother, who introduced me to the world of cooking and taught me my first recipes. From her I learned that love is often expressed through the smell of home-cooked food, a full table, and the desire to always prepare something special for the people we care about.

I thank my husband for his selfless support and endless patience from the very moment this book was just an idea. Countless recipes first passed through your hands (and onto your plate). Thank you for using your gift for photography to make this book a real cookbook – and not just another collection of recipes. Thank you for being part of this story and believing in it from the very beginning.

Special thanks go to my dear friend Nataša, who was with me from the first idea to the last page. Thank you for the proofreading, translations, technical support, building the website, and the countless hours invested in this project. Your help, knowledge, and belief that this book would see the light of day have left their mark on every single page.

And finally, thank you to everyone who has opened this book. I hope its recipes bring you as much joy as they brought me while creating them. May they remind you that the most beautiful memories are often made right at the table, with good food and dear people.

*With love,
Didi*

Introduction

Welcome to my kitchen, where cooking is done with heart and a happy belly!

This treasury didn't happen overnight — it grew through many Sunday mornings when I felt especially inspired to cook, quiet evenings with a cup of tea, the smells drifting from the oven, and the occasional experiment that never happened again (a salute to the salty beet cake!).

My name is Didi. I love cooking, but even more I love preparing food that comforts, nourishes, and brings a smile from the inside out.

These recipes aren't just for your stomach — they're for the day you need some calm, for quiet coffee moments, or for when you don't know what to eat but don't want to put on extra weight either.

No complicated steps here. Just real bites — inspired by sport, yoga, summer, the sea, and the constant urge to add a handful of nuts to everything. All recipes use plant-based milk and are suitable for the lactose intolerant, but can easily be made with regular milk.

In this treasury you'll find recipes that are part of my rhythm — born of pure joy in cooking.

The whole book is written in the feminine form, as if addressing women, but all readers and enthusiastic cooks are warmly welcome to join us on this journey.

If any of my ideas touches your heart (or your stomach) — come back. There's always more!

And know this: every photo in this book was taken literally one second before I (or someone from the household) grabbed the spoon and dove into tasting!

This is not a studio cookbook — it's from life. Everything comes from my kitchen and my personal creativity. Enjoy the reading and the cooking!

With love,

Didi 🍊🌿

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In closing...

Morning Recipes

Sunday Wrap

RECIPE #1

Warm, protein-packed and full of life — perfect for a light breakfast or a quick bite after your workout.

Quick, tasty and sooo satisfying

🕒 Prep time: 10 min



INGREDIENTS

- 1 wholegrain or protein wrap (warm briefly in a dry pan)
- a small piece of feta (around 50g)
- A bit of sharp cheese for a kick (optional)
- A spoonful of Greek yogurt for a lighter version
- Toasted seeds (sunflower, sesame, flax)
- Fresh cucumber (sliced)
- Red and green pepper (sliced into strips)

PREPARATION

1. Warm the wrap in a dry pan until it softens and becomes pliable.
2. Mash the cheeses with a fork and mix in the yogurt.
3. Toast the seeds in a dry pan until fragrant.
4. Combine cheeses and seeds, then spread over the wrap.
5. Add the vegetables and roll up.
6. Toast briefly in the pan and serve with fresh cucumber.

Warm Chickpeas with Yogurt & Tahini

RECIPE #6

Warm, creamy, spiced — for lazy weekend mornings when the day starts without rushing.

This is a traditional Arabic breakfast, just lighter — no frying, no heaviness. I kept the soul but let the body rest and digest more easily.

🕒 Prep time: 15–20 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 1 can of cooked chickpeas (around 200g)
- 1 cup Greek yogurt
- 1 tbsp tahini
- Juice of half a lemon
- Salt, pepper, garlic powder (to taste)
- A little olive oil (optional)
- 2 tbsp nuts (pine nuts, almonds, cashews...)

PREPARATION

1. Rinse the chickpeas well and heat briefly — just to wake them up.
2. Make the sauce from yogurt, tahini, lemon and spices — this sauce is the heart of the dish.
3. Toast the nuts in a dry pan until lightly fragrant.
4. Mix chickpeas and sauce, top with toasted nuts.
5. Add a drizzle of olive oil if you like.
6. Enjoy with toasted bread, pita, or on its own as a low-carb start to the day.

Savoury Breakfast with Flaxseed, Yogurt & Vegetables

RECIPE #14

A crunchy, refreshing combination for a great start to the day.

We're used to sweet yogurt-and-seed bowls, but here's proof that savoury can be even better!

🕒 **Prep time: 5–10 minutes**



INGREDIENTS

- 1 tbsp freshly ground flaxseed
- 200 ml Greek yogurt
- 2 radishes
- 1 spring onion
- 1 tbsp toasted pumpkin seeds
- A pinch of salt

PREPARATION

1. Pour the yogurt into a bowl and stir in the ground flaxseed.
2. Slice the radishes into thin rounds and the spring onion into small rings.
3. Add the vegetables to the bowl, sprinkle with toasted pumpkin seeds and a little salt.
4. Stir gently and serve immediately while the vegetables are still crunchy.

Quinoa Porridge with Blueberries

RECIPE #26

Health and brightness that smell like a new beginning.

This is a breakfast with a feeling of gratitude. Eat it in the quiet before the day gets loud.

🕒 **Prep time: 10 minutes**



INGREDIENTS

- 4 tbsp quinoa flakes
- 200 ml almond milk
- 1 banana (sliced)
- A handful of frozen or fresh blueberries
- A handful of roasted, unsalted peanuts
- 1 tsp honey (optional)
- 1 tsp cinnamon

PREPARATION

1. Warm the almond milk in a small pot and add the quinoa flakes.
2. Let simmer gently for 5–6 minutes, stirring occasionally.
3. Add the mashed banana and cinnamon and cook for another minute or two.
4. Stir in the blueberries while the porridge is still warm.
5. Top with peanuts and sweeten with honey if you like.

Coconut Pancakes with Quick Peach Spread

RECIPE #40

Light exoticism with a summer fruit freshness.

Pancakes are my little happiness ritual, and in this combination of coconut and juicy peaches they become pure summer magic. Fragrant, soft and fruity — they will sweeten your whole day!

🕒 Prep time: 30 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 2 eggs
- 200 ml coconut milk (or regular)
- 100 ml sparkling water
- 120 g flour (wholegrain or white)
- 2 tbsp coconut flour
- 1 tbsp coconut or olive oil
- For the spread: 2–3 ripe peaches, 1 tsp honey, a little lemon juice, a pinch of cinnamon

PREPARATION

1. Whisk the eggs, add the coconut milk and sparkling water.
2. Gradually mix in the flour and coconut flour until you have a smooth batter.
3. Heat the pan and brush with a thin layer of coconut oil. Cook the pancakes until golden on both sides.
4. For the quick spread: peel the peaches, mash with a fork or blend, add lemon juice and honey to taste. Season with cinnamon if desired.
5. Spread the pancakes with the fruit spread and roll or fold.

When I Don't Know What to Cook

Turkey Steak with Caramelised Vegetables & Lemon

RECIPE #15

A quick protein meal after a long day — with a little wine and lots of flavour.

I was tired but didn't want to eat just anything. So I poured myself a glass of wine, put on some music and made myself a proper dinner — then enjoyed it as if I were sitting in a little taverna by the sea.

🕒 Prep time: 25 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 1 turkey breast fillet
- ½ yellow pepper
- 3 cherry tomatoes
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt, pepper, fresh or dried herbs (thyme or oregano)
- Juice of ½ lemon
- Fresh green salad for serving

PREPARATION

1. Slice the pepper into strips and halve the tomatoes.
2. Heat a little olive oil in a pan and fry the turkey on all sides until golden.
3. Add the vegetables alongside the meat and fry briefly until softened and lightly caramelised.
4. Add lemon juice, season everything and let the flavours come together for a minute or two.
5. Serve with fresh salad and a glass of good wine.

Coconut Curry with Red Lentils

RECIPE #16

Because coconut isn't just for desserts. This is a dish that warms the stomach and calms the mind — wherever you are.

This dish creates an opportunity — to pause, breathe, and nourish yourself from within. Red lentils have always been my favourite vegetarian protein, and coconut gives them a sweet summer fragrance.

🕒 **Prep time: 30 minutes**



INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup red lentils
- 1 small onion
- 1 clove of garlic
- A piece of fresh ginger (or ½ tsp dried)
- 1 tsp curry powder
- ½ tsp turmeric
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 cup coconut milk
- 2 cups water
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Fresh parsley or coriander for sprinkling (optional)
- A squeeze of lemon juice when serving

PREPARATION

1. Over low heat, fry the finely chopped onion, garlic and ginger until fragrant.
2. Add curry and turmeric, stir briefly to release the aroma.
3. Add the red lentils, stir, then pour in the coconut milk.
4. Cook for 10–15 minutes until the lentils are soft.
5. Add a cup of water if it gets too thick.
6. Season to taste and let simmer for a few more minutes.
7. Serve warm with a squeeze of lemon juice and fresh herbs.

8. As a side, cook some basmati rice or warm a corn tortilla.

"Live" Lasagne

RECIPE #17

Faster than classic, lighter than the original — and just as warm and delicious.

Who says you have to make homemade pasta sheets to make good lasagne? This recipe was born from a moment when I wanted something substantial — without many dirty pots. Everything raw, everything layered, everything straight into the oven.

🕒 **Prep time: 15 minutes + 30–40 minutes baking**



INGREDIENTS

- 250 g uncooked pasta
- 1 bottle (about 700 ml) tomato passata
- 1 onion
- 1 carrot
- 350 g minced meat (beef or pork, as you like)
- Salt, pepper, oregano, paprika and a pinch of chilli flakes
- 3 bay leaves
- Grated cheese

PREPARATION

1. Finely chop the onion and fry with a little olive oil. Add the mince and carrot, cook until browned. Add all the spices and bay leaves.
2. Add the passata and a little water if needed. The sauce needs to be thin enough for the pasta to cook in it.
3. Simmer the sauce and meat for a few minutes to let the flavours blend.
4. In an ovenproof dish, layer: raw pasta then sauce — repeat until you've used everything. At least two layers.
5. Important: make sure all the pasta is completely covered in liquid.
6. Sprinkle grated cheese on top.
7. Bake in the oven at 180°C for about 30 minutes.

Mediterranean Rice with Lentils

RECIPE #36

A warm dish full of flavour, equally delicious served cold.

Ideal as a nourishing dinner, but also as a light lunch to take to work.

🕒 **Prep time: 30–40 minutes**



INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup rice (wholegrain or basmati)
- 1 cup lentils (green or black)
- 1 carrot
- 1 tomato
- Olive oil
- Spices: oregano, coriander, mint, salt

PREPARATION

1. Rinse the rice and lentils well under cold water.
2. Heat a tablespoon of olive oil in a pot and briefly sauté the finely chopped carrot.
3. Add the diced tomato and wait for it to release its juices.
4. Add the rice and lentils, stir and pour in about 500 ml of water.
5. Add the dried spices, reduce the heat and cook covered for 25–30 minutes until tender.
6. Add a little more water if needed to keep the dish moist.

Creamy Carrot, Celery & Ginger Soup

RECIPE #38

Warm orange magic for body and soul.

Warm, fragrant and quick — this soup is a real hug in a bowl! It came together without much planning, yet turned out so good it went straight into the treasury.

🕒 Prep time: about 35 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 4 large carrots (or 6 small)
- 2 medium potatoes
- 2 celery stalks
- 1 garlic clove
- A piece of fresh ginger (about 2–3 cm)
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 750 ml vegetable stock or water
- Salt and pepper to taste
- A pinch of turmeric

PREPARATION

1. Heat the olive oil in a pot and briefly sauté the finely chopped garlic.
2. Add the carrots, potatoes and celery and sauté for a few minutes until fragrant.
3. Stir in the grated ginger and turmeric.
4. Pour in the stock, season with salt and pepper, and cook until the vegetables are soft (20–25 minutes).
5. Blend everything into a smooth cream soup.
6. Garnish with a drizzle of olive oil, fresh parsley or pumpkin seeds if desired.

Turkey with Aubergine and Pasta

RECIPE #41

A classic stew, but with aubergine that transforms it into something entirely new.

This stew is a true combination of juiciness and health. The aubergine melts into the sauce and adds richness — my trick for turning a classic stew into something special.

🕒 Prep time: 30 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 300 g turkey fillet
- 1 aubergine (degorged)
- 1 red pepper
- 1 carrot
- 1 onion (white or red)
- 400 g peeled tomatoes (or tomato sauce)
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt, pepper, dried oregano, basil to taste
- 200 g pasta

PREPARATION

1. Sauté the chopped onion and carrot in olive oil.
2. Add the diced turkey fillet and cook until it turns white.
3. Stir in the aubergine and pepper and sauté for a few more minutes.
4. Add the tomatoes, season with salt, pepper, oregano and basil. Cook for 20 minutes until the vegetables are soft.
5. Meanwhile, cook the pasta.
6. Serve the stew over the pasta and sprinkle with fresh basil.

Pan-Fried Potatoes – My Grandma's Favourite

RECIPE #43

Simple, fragrant and filling — a dish for every occasion.

This dish is proof that even the simplest ingredients can make a real feast. The perfect choice when you want something quick, tasty and filling.

🕒 **Prep time: about 30 minutes**



INGREDIENTS

- 3–4 potatoes
- 1 onion
- A little oil for frying
- Salt, pepper
- 1 tsp paprika

PREPARATION

1. Peel the potatoes, cut into cubes and cook in water (don't overcook!).
2. Sauté the finely chopped onion in a little oil until translucent.
3. Add the potatoes, season with salt, pepper and paprika.
4. Mix everything well and fry briefly to let the flavours come together.

Mini Aubergine Pizzas

RECIPE #7

Light bites with a touch of Mediterranean summer — perfect when you want something warm and full of flavour.

Aubergine as the base instead of dough, tomato and oregano to fill the house with fragrance, olives and cheese for that homemade feel — like something from grandma's old kitchen.

🕒 **Prep time: 45 minutes (including baking)**



INGREDIENTS

- 1 aubergine, sliced into rounds (about 1 cm thick), salted to remove bitterness
- Tomato, sliced into rounds
- Black or green olives
- Grated cheese of your choice
- Olive oil (about 1 tbsp)
- Oregano, to taste

PREPARATION

1. Arrange the aubergine slices in a baking tray.
2. Drizzle with a little olive oil.
3. Sprinkle with grated cheese.
4. Top with tomato slices, olives and mushrooms if you like.
5. Sprinkle everything with oregano.
6. Bake in a preheated oven for about 30 minutes, until the house smells of the Mediterranean.
7. Serve warm with toasted bread or boiled potatoes.

Beef Stew with Green Beans

RECIPE #46

Classic home-style stew with a refreshing green note.

This dish was born from a desire to unite strength and lightness — the richness of beef and the refreshing touch of green beans. Perfect for cold October days.

🕒 Prep time: about 60 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 500 g beef (leg or shoulder)
- 300 g green beans
- 2 onions
- 2 garlic cloves
- 1 carrot
- 2 ripe tomatoes (peeled and chopped)
- 1 tbsp tomato paste
- 1 tbsp flour
- 1 tsp sweet ground paprika
- 2 bay leaves
- Salt, pepper, olive oil

PREPARATION

1. Sauté the chopped onion over medium heat until translucent.
2. Add the beef cut into cubes and brown on all sides.
3. Stir in the flour and paprika, then add the fresh tomatoes, tomato paste and carrot.
4. Pour in warm water to cover the meat, add the bay leaves and cook over low heat for about 30 minutes.
5. Halfway through cooking add the green beans and a little more water if needed. Cook for another 30 minutes until the flavours have melded.

Creamy Zucchini Soup

RECIPE #28

Delicate, fragrant and easy on the stomach.

This is a soup that warms your stomach and clears your head — simple, gentle and soft like the first sip of warmth after a cold day.

🕒 Prep time: 30 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 2 medium zucchini
- 1 small potato
- 1 small onion
- 1 garlic clove
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt and pepper
- A little fresh parsley or dill
- Around 600 ml water or vegetable stock
- A handful of sunflower seeds for serving

PREPARATION

1. Sauté the finely chopped onion and garlic in olive oil briefly.
2. Add the zucchini in slices and potato in cubes, stir everything together.
3. Add enough water or stock to cover the vegetables, season with salt and pepper.
4. Cook for about 15 minutes until everything is soft.
5. Blend with a stick blender or in a blender until smooth and creamy.
6. Stir in a little fresh parsley to taste.
7. Before serving, sprinkle with sunflower seeds for a pleasant crunch.

Prebranac with Sweet Potato

RECIPE #53

Tradition in a new spirit.

This dish is my little bridge between childhood and today's way of eating. Classic prebranac gets a new, gentler version thanks to the sweet potato, and the roasted peppers give it a warm homely aroma.

🕒 Prep time: 60 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 400 g tinned red kidney beans
- 1 medium sweet potato
- 2 onions
- 2–3 red sweet peppers
- Oil of your choice
- Salt, pepper, paprika powder
- 2–3 bay leaves

PREPARATION

1. Finely chop the onions and sauté in oil until softened.
2. Rinse the tinned beans under cold water and add to the onions.
3. Peel the sweet potato, dice and add to the vegetables.
4. Season with salt, pepper and paprika, then cook over low heat for about 10 minutes.
5. Near the end of cooking, partially mash the beans with a spoon to get a creamy mixture.
6. Fill the peppers with the mixture and bake at 180°C until the peppers are soft.

Pasta with Green Pesto & Salmon

RECIPE #32

An interesting pasta that brings green pesto and delicate salmon together in a quick, nourishing meal.

When I look in the fridge and see salmon and a jar of pesto, I know dinner can be ready in 20 minutes and will be really good.

🕒 Prep time: 20 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 200 g pasta (penne, fusilli or whatever you have)
- 200 g salmon fillet
- 2–3 tbsp green pesto
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 small garlic clove, finely chopped
- A few drops of lemon juice
- Salt and pepper to taste
- A handful of rocket or fresh basil

PREPARATION

1. Cook the pasta al dente according to packet instructions.
2. Sauté the finely chopped garlic in olive oil for a minute or two.
3. Add the salmon fillet and cook until opaque, about 5–7 minutes. Break it up with a fork.
4. Add the cooked pasta and pesto, toss everything together.
5. Add a few drops of lemon juice, salt and pepper to taste.
6. Serve topped with a handful of rocket or fresh basil.

Delicious Oven-Roasted Brussels Sprouts

RECIPE #34

All it takes is one ingredient and a little creativity to turn the most humble vegetable into a star.

Brussels sprouts are a vegetable many people avoid, but I discovered them late and now make them every week. From the oven they come out caramelised, crispy and completely different from boiled.

🕒 Prep time: 5 minutes + 25–30 minutes roasting



INGREDIENTS

- Around 10 Brussels sprouts
- A little olive oil
- Salt to taste
- Paprika to taste

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C.
2. Wash the sprouts, remove outer leaves and cut in half.
3. Place cut-side down on a baking tray.
4. Drizzle with olive oil and season generously with salt and paprika.
5. Roast for 25–30 minutes until the edges are golden and crispy.
6. Serve warm — as a side dish or a meal on its own.

Refreshing Recipes

Crunchy Celery Salad

BONUS RECIPE

Refreshment after work – between lunch and dinner

This salad was a real discovery for me! Perfect as a quick fix after work when it's hot outside and you need something light, crunchy, and nourishing.

🕒 Prep time: 10 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 2–3 celery stalks (finely chopped)
- 1 carrot (grated)
- 1 apple (diced)
- a handful of pumpkin seeds (lightly dry-toasted)
- 2 tbsp Greek yogurt
- 1 tsp olive oil
- a little lemon juice
- a pinch of salt

PREPARATION

1. Mix the vegetables and apple.
2. Add the toasted pumpkin seeds.
3. Whisk a creamy dressing from yogurt, oil, lemon, and salt.
4. Combine everything and enjoy.

Note: For a heartier meal, add a little hummus on the side.

Unusual Beetroot Salad

RECIPE #29

Colourful freshness on a plate.

A dish that opens the heart and brings a smile — as a snack, side or light dinner.

🕒 Prep time: 20 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 3 cooked beetroots
- 2 carrots
- 1 green pepper
- 2 spring onions
- 1 tin Mexican mix (sweetcorn, red kidney beans, red pepper)
- Olive oil
- Balsamic vinegar
- Salt and pepper to taste

PREPARATION

1. Cut the cooked beetroot into cubes.
2. Add the chopped pepper, carrot and spring onion.
3. Stir in the corn and beans.
4. Season with olive oil, balsamic vinegar, salt and pepper.
5. Mix well and serve chilled.

Quick Tapas

RECIPE #47

When your body knows what it needs.

This meal is inspired by Spanish tapas — small tasty bites served in several small dishes and shared with friends. This time I ate it alone and enjoyed every flavourful moment.

🕒 Prep time: 5 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- A few thin slices of Serrano or Parma ham
- A few cubes of hard cheese (cheddar or your choice)
- A handful of white grapes
- 5–6 black olives
- 2 slices of wholegrain bread
- A few cherry tomatoes and cucumber slices

PREPARATION

1. You don't cook — you arrange.
2. Let your feeling guide you — no scales, no measuring.
3. Let the plate be a little picture of your current mood.

Detox Beetroot and Pomegranate Salad

RECIPE #52

A ruby on the plate! Fresh, vivid and full of vitality.

I love this salad because it is like a little vitamin bomb — it wakes you up, clears the mind and puts a smile on your face. Simple, yet looking like it was made for a special occasion.

🕒 Prep time: 10 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 500 g cooked beetroot
- ½ pomegranate (seeds only)
- A handful of fresh parsley
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- A pinch of salt and pepper

PREPARATION

1. Cut the cooked beetroot into cubes or thin slices.
2. Sprinkle with fresh pomegranate seeds and finely chopped parsley.
3. Mix the olive oil, lemon juice, salt and pepper.
4. Pour the dressing over the salad, toss gently and leave for 5 minutes for the flavours to meld.

Tuna Bowl

RECIPE #10

Tuna meal for a full stomach and a clear head

This bowl was born on one of those evenings when I had no energy to cook, but I knew my body still deserved some care after a long day. Everything was there — in the fridge, then in a bowl.

🕒 Prep time: 10 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup cooked rice (or quinoa)
- ½ can of tuna (in water or olive oil)
- 2 tbsp Mexican mix (red beans and corn)
- ½ fresh cucumber, diced
- 6–8 green olives
- Juice of ¼ lemon
- Salt and pepper to taste

PREPARATION

1. Place your base at the bottom of the bowl — rice or quinoa.
2. Layer the tuna, corn and beans on top.
3. Add cucumber and olives.
4. Drizzle with lemon juice and season to taste.
5. Stir gently or eat in layers — your day, your rules.

Rocket Salad with Beetroot, Feta & Walnuts

RECIPE #45

A little bomb of freshness and flavour.

This salad is like a little firework on the plate — sweet beetroot, peppery rocket, creamy feta and crunchy walnuts create a harmonious play of flavours.

🕒 Prep time: 15 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 2 handfuls of fresh rocket
- 2 cooked beetroots (cut into cubes or slices)
- 100 g feta cheese
- 1 handful of walnuts (lightly toasted in a dry pan)
- Olive oil
- Juice of half a lemon
- Salt and pepper to taste

PREPARATION

1. Arrange the rocket as a base on the plate.
2. Add the cooked and sliced beetroot.
3. Crumble feta over the top and sprinkle with walnuts.
4. Drizzle with olive oil and lemon juice, and season with salt and pepper.

Broccoli with Pine Nuts

RECIPE #30

A green dish that restores balance.

The ideal recipe for days when you need something light but super nourishing.

🕒 **Prep time: 20 minutes**



INGREDIENTS

- 200 g broccoli
- 2 tbsp Greek yogurt
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp pine nuts
- Juice of half a lemon
- A pinch of salt

PREPARATION

1. Divide the broccoli into small florets and blanch for just 3–4 minutes in boiling water until slightly tender.
2. Immediately transfer to cold water to preserve the colour and freshness.
3. In a small bowl, combine Greek yogurt, lemon juice, olive oil and salt into a smooth cream.
4. Arrange the broccoli on a plate, drizzle with the cream and scatter pine nuts on top.

Power Fruit Bowl

RECIPE #4

Light, fruity and just right — for when you don't want to weigh down your stomach before bed but still want to feed your soul.

I wasn't very hungry, but I knew I would be soon. I didn't want to fool myself — the body knows. So I gave it this little fruity yes.

🕒 Prep time: 10 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 1 banana
- 1 kiwi
- half an apple
- 2 dates
- A pinch of cinnamon
- A handful of walnuts or almonds
- A little fresh lemon juice
- 1 tsp tahini or honey

PREPARATION

1. Peel and chop the fruit into bite-sized pieces.
2. Drizzle with lemon juice to keep everything fresh and fragrant.
3. Sprinkle with cinnamon and gently stir.
4. Add walnuts or almonds — whatever you have on hand.
5. Finish with tahini, honey, or nothing at all.

From the Oven

Banana Bread with Raisins

RECIPE #12

For when you need something that smells like home — half bread, half cake, all comfort.

This bread is my go-to for breakfast or dinner on cold autumn days. I beat the egg whites separately until fluffy, to keep everything light and soft.

🕒 Prep time: 15 minutes + 45 minutes baking



INGREDIENTS

- 2 ripe bananas
- 2 eggs (whites and yolks separated)
- 2 tbsp honey or sugar
- 1 sachet vanilla
- 1 sachet baking powder
- A pinch of salt
- 200 g wholegrain or oat flour
- A handful of chopped walnuts
- A handful of raisins
- 1 tsp cinnamon

PREPARATION

1. Mash the bananas with a fork and mix with the egg yolks, honey and vanilla.
2. Add flour, baking powder, a pinch of salt and cinnamon if you like.
3. Fold in the walnuts and raisins.
4. Beat the egg whites separately until fluffy, then gently fold into the batter.
5. Pour into a lined baking tin.
6. Bake in a preheated oven at 180°C for 30–35 minutes.
7. Cool, slice, enjoy.

Wholegrain Seeded Bread

RECIPE #25

A traditional recipe as a small work of art.

There is no better way to start the morning than with fresh, fragrant bread from your own oven. All you need is a few ingredients: two willing hands, a sunny Sunday morning and a little love for baking.

🕒 **Prep time: about 2 hours (including proving time)**



INGREDIENTS

- 400–500 g wholegrain flour
- 1 tsp salt
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 1 cube fresh yeast (40 g) or 1 sachet dried yeast
- 200 ml lukewarm water
- 2 tbsp sunflower seeds
- 2 tbsp pumpkin seeds
- Cumin or sesame seeds for sprinkling

PREPARATION

1. Dissolve the yeast in a little lukewarm water with a pinch of flour and sugar, and leave to foam.
2. In a larger bowl, mix flour, salt, seeds and oil. Add the activated yeast and the rest of the water. Knead into a smooth, soft dough.
3. Cover with a cloth and leave to rise for 45–60 minutes.
4. Once risen, knock back and shape into a round loaf. Score the top with a sharp knife — a leaf, cross or spiral.
5. Brush with beaten egg and sprinkle with cumin or sesame seeds.
6. Bake in a preheated oven at 220°C for 30–35 minutes without a fan, until fragrant and golden.

Puff Pastry Rolls with Minced Meat

RECIPE #49

Fragrant bites that get you moving!

A simple dish that requires little time or effort, yet delivers the satisfaction of home cooking. When the aroma of baked puff pastry and seasoned meat meet — it is hard to stop at just one roll!

🕒 Prep time: 40 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 1 pack of puff pastry (ready-made)
- 200 g minced meat
- 1 red pepper
- 1 onion
- Salt, pepper and caraway seeds to taste

PREPARATION

1. Keep the puff pastry in the fridge until just before shaping — it is easier to work with and stays crispy.
2. Mix the minced meat, finely chopped onion and pepper in a bowl. No pre-cooking needed.
3. Preheat the oven to 200°C.
4. Roll out the puff pastry and spread the filling evenly right to the edges.
5. Roll the pastry into a log and cut into rounds with a sharp knife.
6. Sprinkle with caraway seeds and place on a parchment-lined tray. Reduce the temperature to 180°C and bake for about 25 minutes with fan.

Slow Gingerbreads from a Switched-Off Oven

RECIPE #8

Because cookies love to rest too, not to burn.

These gingerbreads don't follow rules — they follow feeling. You don't count minutes, you don't check the oven, you don't chase perfection. You just knead with your hands, smell the kitchen fill with warmth, and trust.

🕒 **Prep time: 15 minutes + drying in a switched-off oven**



INGREDIENTS

- 200–300 g wholegrain flour
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- A pinch of cardamom
- 2 handfuls of raisins
- A handful of chopped walnuts
- 2 heaped tbsp honey
- Around 50 ml oil
- A little plant milk (only if the mixture is too dry)

PREPARATION

1. Mix the dry ingredients.
2. In a separate bowl, combine honey and oil, then add to the dry ingredients.
3. Knead the dough with your hands — soft but compact.
4. Shape the gingerbreads and place on baking paper.
5. Heat the oven to 220°C. Put the tray in and immediately switch the oven off!
6. Do not open the oven until it has fully cooled — trust the process.
7. Remove, let cool, then transfer to a bowl or jar with a lid.

Forest Fruit Pie

RECIPE #44

Crispy, juicy and refreshing — a dessert that unites the tart notes of forest fruit with pleasant sweetness.

This pie is my secret way to quickly make something that looks like I spent all day in the kitchen. In reality — you just need pastry sheets, a little fruit and a lot of love.

🕒 **Prep time: 15 minutes + 20 minutes baking**



INGREDIENTS

- 300 g thin pastry sheets (filo)
- 500 g mixed forest fruit (fresh or frozen)
- 3 tbsp sugar or honey
- 2 eggs
- 50 g melted butter
- 1 sachet vanilla sugar
- 100 ml water

PREPARATION

1. Mix the eggs, sugar, vanilla sugar, butter and water in a bowl.
2. Line a baking tray with parchment paper.
3. Fold two pastry sheets at a time like an accordion and arrange lengthwise in the tin.
4. Alternate between adding the egg mixture and the fruit between the layers until everything is used up.
5. Bake at 180°C fan for about 20 minutes until golden.
6. Leave to cool slightly before cutting into squares and enjoy.

Winter Cake with Pumpkin and Carrots

RECIPE #51

Cake without added sugar — just the natural sweetness of fruit and vegetables.

The warmth of pumpkin and cinnamon in every bite — perfect for November evenings with tea and a hug.

🕒 **Prep time: 40 minutes**



INGREDIENTS

- 3 eggs (whites and yolks beaten separately)
- ½ butternut squash (grated)
- 2 carrots (grated)
- 3–4 tbsp wholemeal flour
- 2 heaped tbsp raisins
- about 50 g melted butter
- 1–2 sachets vanilla sugar
- Juice of ½ lemon and zest
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- A pinch of cardamom and salt
- 1 sachet baking powder
- Chopped walnuts for sprinkling

PREPARATION

1. Beat the egg whites with the lemon juice and zest to stiff peaks.
2. Add the egg yolks with the melted butter, then the raisins, pumpkin and carrots.
3. Mix in the spices, then gradually add the flour mixed with the baking powder.
4. Pour into a parchment-lined tin and sprinkle with chopped walnuts.
5. Bake for about 25 minutes at 180°C fan until the house is fragrant.
6. Allow to cool before cutting.

Vanilla Pudding with Almonds & Raspberries

RECIPE #31

A light, creamy treat with fruity freshness.

Simple, quick and wonderfully fragrant! This is your sweet break after a long day. 🍷

🕒 Prep time: 15 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 1 sachet vanilla pudding powder
- 500 ml almond milk
- 3–4 tbsp desiccated coconut
- 2 tbsp sugar or sweetener to taste
- A handful of fresh raspberries
- A handful of almonds

PREPARATION

1. Pour 400 ml of the almond milk into a pan and bring to the boil.
2. Whisk the pudding powder and sugar into the remaining 100 ml milk.
3. When the milk starts to boil, add the pudding mixture and cook, stirring constantly, until thickened.
4. Near the end, stir in the coconut and combine well.
5. Remove from the heat and pour into bowls or glasses.
6. Chill and top with fresh raspberries and almonds before serving.

With Coffee

Dubai Bites

BONUS RECIPE

A little chocolate indulgence as an ode to Dubai chocolate.

Homemade chocolates inspired by a gentle smile and the lightness of movement.

🕒 **Prep time: 10 minutes + chilling 1–2 hours or longer as desired**



INGREDIENTS

- 2–3 tbsp pistachio cream
- 1 tbsp tahini
- about two handfuls of shredded kadaif pastry
- dark chocolate (70–80% cocoa), melted

PREPARATION

1. Mix the pistachio cream and tahini until smooth.
2. Add the kadaif and gently fold in, keeping it crunchy.
3. Scoop out small bites with a spoon and shape with your hands.
4. Refrigerate for about an hour to set.
5. Melt the chocolate and coat the bites using two forks.

Note: These bites are like a little sweet reward after a workout or yoga. Keep them in the freezer and take out as needed.

Creamy Chocolate Rice Pudding

RECIPE #11

A bite that says: you don't have to be superwoman, just hungry and honest.

Born on an evening when I was craving the smell of childhood, but now in my version. Warm, sweet — without milk and sugar.

🕒 Prep time: 20–25 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup round-grain or pudding rice
- 1 cup plant milk (or regular milk if preferred)
- A pinch of salt
- Real vanilla or vanilla sugar (to taste)
- 2 dates, chopped
- 2 squares of dark chocolate, finely chopped
- ½ tsp cinnamon

PREPARATION

1. Rinse the rice and cook in plant milk with a pinch of salt.
2. Simmer on low heat until the rice is soft and has absorbed most of the liquid.
3. Add vanilla and stir.
4. Remove from heat and transfer to a bowl.
5. Top with chopped dates, chocolate and a little cinnamon.
6. Add a cinnamon stick if you want a romantic touch.

Royal Date Balls

RECIPE #35

Natural sweetness for every moment of peace and pleasure.

Born from a pure desire for something sweet without guilt. I love them because I can make them in five minutes, and every bite feels indulgent.

🕒 Prep time: 5–10 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 6 Medjool dates
- 2 handfuls of chopped walnuts
- 1 tbsp tahini
- Unsweetened cocoa powder for rolling

PREPARATION

1. Wash the dates and soak in warm water until soft.
2. Finely chop the walnuts.
3. Cut open the dates, remove the stones and place in a food processor with the walnuts.
4. Add tahini and blend briefly — just until the mixture comes together.
5. Scoop out with a spoon and roll into small balls with your hands.
6. Roll in cocoa powder, coconut or ground pistachios as desired.

Quick Banana Cookies

RECIPE #37

A spur-of-the-moment treat — crispy outside, soft inside.

The bananas on the counter were browning, the oven was already on — time for a little experiment. These soft, fragrant cookies were born unplanned and perfectly simple.

🕒 **Prep time: 5 minutes + 25 minutes baking**



INGREDIENTS

- 2 ripe bananas
- A handful of oats
- 2 tbsp raisins
- A small knob of melted butter
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- A pinch of cardamom
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1 tbsp wholemeal flour

PREPARATION

1. Mash the bananas with a fork.
2. Add the oats, raisins and melted butter.
3. Mix in the cinnamon, cardamom, baking powder and flour.
4. Shape into small cookies with a spoon and place on a baking tray lined with parchment.
5. Bake at 180°C for about 25 minutes until golden and fragrant.

Flourless Jaffa Cake

RECIPE #33

Moist, healthy and refined — enriched with dark chocolate.

A real little treasure trove of flavour and nutrients in just one slice. Flourless, but full of fruit and hazelnuts — feels light yet rich enough to restore your energy and lift your mood.

🕒 **Prep time: 10 minutes + 40 minutes baking**



INGREDIENTS

- 4 medium carrots
- 1 tart apple
- 50 g melted butter
- 200 g ground hazelnuts
- 1 tbsp sugar or honey
- Zest of one orange and juice of half an orange
- 1 tsp cinnamon and a pinch of salt
- 100 g milk or dark chocolate
- A little plant milk (for the glaze)

PREPARATION

1. Wash and grate the carrots and apple, mix well.
2. Gradually add the ground hazelnuts, butter and honey, stirring gently with a spoon until the mixture is even.
3. Add the orange zest, juice, cinnamon and salt.
4. Pour into a greased tin and bake at 180°C for about 40 minutes.
5. Near the end of baking, melt the chocolate with a little plant milk and pour over the warm cake.

The Most Chocolatey Brownie

RECIPE #48

Sweet anti-stress for PMS and other crisis days.

I don't believe in miracle pills, but I believe in chocolate. A warm brownie, soft inside, crispy at the edges — and the aroma to remind you that life is actually wonderful.

🕒 Prep time: 15 minutes + 25–30 minutes baking



INGREDIENTS

- 100 g dark chocolate (min. 70% cocoa)
- 50 g butter
- 2 eggs
- 50 g coconut or brown sugar
- 100 g wholemeal flour
- 2 tbsp cocoa powder
- A pinch of salt
- 1 tsp vanilla
- A handful of chopped walnuts or hazelnuts (optional)
- Strawberries for decoration

PREPARATION

1. Melt the chocolate and butter in a bain-marie.
2. Whisk the eggs with the sugar and vanilla, then add the chocolate mixture.
3. Mix in the flour, cocoa and salt by hand so the batter stays thick and sticky.
4. Add nuts if desired.
5. Bake for 25–30 minutes at 180°C in a parchment-lined tin. The centre should remain soft, not fully set.
6. Allow to cool slightly, then decorate with strawberries.

Croissants with Dark Chocolate

RECIPE #50

A sweet cloud of happiness that melts in your mouth!

The aroma that fills the house the moment they go in the oven — has to be experienced! These are the croissants that make you forget time and all your obligations.

🕒 Prep time: 25 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 1 pack of puff pastry (rectangular)
- 100 g dark chocolate
- Water for brushing
- 2 tbsp chopped almonds
- 1 tbsp icing sugar

PREPARATION

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C.
2. Roll out the puff pastry and cut diagonally into triangles.
3. Place a piece of dark chocolate at the wider end of each triangle.
4. Roll the croissants towards the narrow end and gently curve the tips to hold their shape.
5. Brush with water and sprinkle with chopped almonds.
6. Bake on parchment paper for about 20 minutes until golden and fragrant.
7. Finish with a dusting of icing sugar once they have cooled slightly.

"Fake" Choco Rolls

RECIPE #9

They look like chocolate, smell like chocolate, melt like chocolate — but with not a trace of actual chocolate!

This spread started as my homemade Nutella alternative — for those moments when I wanted something sweet but not industrial. First it was for pancakes, then these little, delicate rolls were born all by themselves.

🕒 **Prep time: 10 minutes + chilling**



INGREDIENTS

- 1 thin lavash, tortilla, or homemade neutral crêpe
- 1 tbsp peanut butter
- 1 tbsp honey
- 1 tsp unsweetened cocoa powder
- Optional: a pinch of cinnamon or vanilla

PREPARATION

1. In a small bowl, combine peanut butter, honey and cocoa until you have a thick, spreadable cream.
2. Add cinnamon or vanilla if you like.
3. Spread the cream over the entire surface of the lavash or crêpe.
4. Roll up carefully and refrigerate for 10–15 minutes to firm up.
5. Slice into small rolls and serve as a snack with tea, coffee or plant milk.

Spreads & Dips

Homemade Hummus with Parsley

RECIPE #39

Fragrant breakfast or snack that fills you with energy and delights the eye.

This is my favourite hummus with colourful vegetables — a little ritual of enjoyment. Colours, aromas and textures make every bite pure joy.

🕒 Prep time: 15–20 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 200 g cooked chickpeas (from a jar or tin)
- 2–3 tbsp dark tahini
- 2 tbsp olive oil + a little for decoration
- Juice of half a lemon
- 1 garlic clove
- Salt to taste
- 1–2 tbsp cold water (as needed)
- Fresh parsley for decoration

PREPARATION

1. Place the chickpeas, tahini, olive oil, lemon juice and garlic in a blender or food processor.
2. Blend until smooth and creamy, adding cold water a tablespoon at a time as needed.
3. Season with salt and pepper.
4. Chop the fresh parsley.
5. Serve in a bowl, sprinkle with parsley and drizzle with olive oil.

Protein Spread from Boiled Eggs

RECIPE #42

Quick and nourishing breakfast with a refreshing taste.

Perfect for breakfast or a light dinner — creamy, crunchy from the radishes and refreshing with vegetables. On wholegrain bread or as a tortilla filling — always a success.

🕒 Prep time: 10 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 2 hard-boiled eggs
- 3 small radishes
- 1 spring onion
- 1–2 tsp mustard
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste

PREPARATION

1. Finely chop or mash the eggs with a fork.
2. Add the finely chopped radishes and spring onion.
3. Mix in the mustard, olive oil, salt and pepper.
4. Serve with fresh salad, tomatoes or wholegrain bread.

Homemade Tuna Pâté

RECIPE #54

Simple pâté — no unnecessary additions, just the way I like it.

This is the type of recipe that saves breakfast, dinner or the "nothing in the fridge" moment. Minimal ingredients, maximum flavour.

🕒 Prep time: 5 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 1 large tin of tuna in its own juice
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 2–3 tsp mustard
- Lemon juice and salt to taste
- Vegetables for decoration

PREPARATION

1. Drain the tuna and place in a food processor or chopper.
2. Blend briefly to break it up.
3. Add the mustard, olive oil, lemon juice and salt.
4. Continue blending until you have a smooth, creamy mixture.
5. Taste and adjust the acidity, saltiness or oil as needed.

Colourful Avocado Spread

BONUS RECIPE

Creamy freshness with a sweet surprise.

This spread was born from a desire for something light yet full of life. Avocado gives creaminess and healthy fats, red onion brings freshness, and corn adds a mysterious sweet note.

🕒 Prep time: 10 minutes

INGREDIENTS

- 1 ripe avocado
- 2 tbsp cooked corn
- 2 tbsp finely chopped red onion
- 1 tsp olive oil
- juice of half a lemon
- a pinch of salt
- optional: a little freshly ground pepper or chopped parsley

PREPARATION

1. Halve the avocado, remove the stone, and scoop the flesh into a bowl.
2. Mash finely with a fork.
3. Add the corn and finely chopped red onion.
4. Mix in the olive oil, lemon juice, and salt.
5. Stir gently until everything is combined.

Note: Best served immediately. Keeps for a few hours in the fridge covered with cling film pressed onto the surface. Excellent on wholegrain bread, tortillas, or as a salad topping.

Delicious Oven-Roasted Brussels Sprouts

RECIPE #34

All it takes is one ingredient and a little creativity to turn the most humble vegetable into a star.

Brussels sprouts are a vegetable many people avoid, but I discovered them late and now make them every week. From the oven they come out caramelised, crispy and completely different from boiled.

🕒 Vreme pripreme: 5 minutes + 25–30 minutes roasting



SASTOJCI

- Around 10 Brussels sprouts
- A little olive oil
- Salt to taste
- Paprika to taste

PRIPREMA

1. Preheat the oven to 200°C.
2. Wash the sprouts, remove outer leaves and cut in half.
3. Place cut-side down on a baking tray.
4. Drizzle with olive oil and season generously with salt and paprika.
5. Roast for 25–30 minutes until the edges are golden and crispy.
6. Serve warm — as a side dish or a meal on its own.

In closing...

This is not a book about diets.

No calorie tables, no counting portions, no prohibitions, and no guilt.

This is a cookbook and an invitation to love yourself through food.

The recipes you've found here aren't low-calorie, but they are **gently balanced** — just like the life you want to live.

Food is here to nourish us, calm us, delight us, and remind us: when you move, breathe, laugh, and love — everything else falls into place.

And remember: whatever is happening right now — it all works out in the end!

Don't count calories.

Count smiles. Steps. Beautiful bites.

Exercise and enjoy the moments and the small, simple things. Smile for no reason.

Thank you for cooking with me.

This book may be finished, but your kitchen adventure is just beginning.

From a small kitchen, with lots of love,

Didi

Bremen, spring 2026.

Ajvar Sticks

RECIPE #55

Crispy puff pastry bites with ajvar

A little puff pastry, ajvar and sesame, and you've got a snack that disappears from the table faster than you planned.

🕒 Prep time: about 25 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 2 packs of puff pastry
- 2–3 tbsp ajvar
- a little salt
- sesame seeds

PREPARATION

1. Roll out the first sheet of puff pastry and spread ajvar over the entire surface, edge to edge.
2. Cover with the second sheet and press lightly so the layers stick together.
3. Cut the pastry into strips about 2–3 cm wide, then twist each strip several times along its axis.
4. Arrange the sticks on a baking tray lined with baking paper, sprinkle with a little salt and sesame seeds.
5. Bake in a preheated oven at 180°C for about 20 minutes, or until golden brown and crispy.

Note: Best enjoyed while still slightly warm — if you can manage not to eat them immediately. 😊

Cheese Burek

RECIPE #56

The star of my kitchen and Instagram

Some recipes are simply born to be stars. In my home it's already won over both the kitchen and Instagram — so it was high time it got its place here too.

🕒 Prep time: about 30 minutes



INGREDIENTS

- 250 g thin filo pastry sheets
- 350 g crumbly white cheese
- 2–3 tbsp oil
- 50 ml warm water

PREPARATION

1. Mix the oil with warm water.
2. In a round baking tin, lay four pastry sheets from four sides — top, bottom, left and right — so half of each sheet sits in the tin and the other half hangs over the edge. Brush each sheet with the oil-water mixture.
3. Place one more sheet on the bottom of the tin, brush it, then spread half the cheese over it.
4. Layer three more sheets on top of the cheese, brushing each one well with the oil-water mixture.
5. Spread the remaining cheese over the third sheet.
6. Cover with the remaining sheets, continuing to brush each one with oil and water.
7. Finally, fold the overhanging sheet halves over the filling to wrap the burek.
8. Brush everything once more with oil so the top bakes up golden and crispy.
9. Bake in a preheated oven at 180°C for about 25 minutes, or until the burek is nicely golden.

Note: Then just cut through that crispy crust and listen to the sound. 😊

Savoury Seed Crackers

RECIPE #57

Thin, crispy and full of seeds

If you love snacks but want something a little different from classic crackers, try these seed ones. They're crispy, full of flavour and great with a spread, cheese or just on their own. The key thing is to spread the mixture thin enough — that's when they get really nicely crispy.

🕒 **Vreme pripreme: about 55 minutes**



SASTOJCI

- 50 g muesli
- 3 tbsp flaxseeds
- 3 tbsp chia seeds
- 3 tbsp sesame seeds
- 3 tbsp sunflower seeds
- 3 tbsp pumpkin seeds
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp paprika
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp cumin, to taste
- 150 ml warm water

PRIPREMA

1. Mix the muesli, all seeds and spices in a bowl.
2. Pour over the warm water and mix well.
3. Leave the mixture to sit for about 15 minutes so the seeds swell and everything becomes nicely sticky.
4. Transfer the mixture onto baking paper and spread into a very thin layer, about 5 mm thick.
5. Bake in a preheated fan oven at 160°C for about 40 minutes, or until the crackers are dry and crispy.
6. Leave to cool briefly, then break into pieces.

Napomena: And yes — the thinner, the crispier. 😊